

Isaiah Fink Avraham Cohen
Curriculum Vitae
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Sociology, Louisiana State University	May 2020
M.A. Sociology, Louisiana State University	May 2015
B.A. Political Science with Sociology minor, Shippensburg University	December 2011
A.A. General Studies, Harrisburg Area Community College	July 2009

POSITIONS HELD

<i>Assistant Professor</i> , University of South Dakota	August 2021 – Present
<i>Visiting Assistant Professor</i> , University of South Dakota	August 2020 – May 2021
<i>Graduate Instructor</i> , Louisiana State University	August 2016 – May 2020
<i>Graduate Assistant</i> , Louisiana State University	September 2013 – May 2020

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Education	Sociology of Law	Deviance
Theory	Child Development	Criminology
Family	Quantitative Methods	Qualitative Methods

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 [“Signals from the School: Do Positive and Negative Messages Shape Family Involvement?”](#)
Isaiah F. A. Cohen and Mark Schafer. *The Sociological Quarterly*.
- 2024 [“Promoting Student Agency in the Social Sciences with the Digital Unessay.”](#) Isaiah Cohen and
Chris Adamson. *Visualizing Objects, Places, and Spaces: A Digital Project Handbook*.
- 2024 [“Promoting Student Agency in the Humanities with the Digital Unessay.”](#) Chris Adamson and
Isaiah Cohen. *Visualizing Objects, Places, and Spaces: A Digital Project Handbook*.
- 2019 [“How is gentrification associated with changes in the academic performance of
Neighborhood schools?”](#) Michael S. Barton and Isaiah F. A. Cohen. *Social Science Research*.
80: 230-242.
- 2017 [“Neighborhood Perception and Self-Rated Health among Older Mexican Americans.”](#) Samuel
Stroope, Isaiah F. A. Cohen, Joshua C. Tom, Aaron B. Franzen, and Kyriakos S. Markides.
Geriatrics & Gerontology International. 17(12):2559-2564
- 2017 [“Homeschooling Grows in Louisiana and the United States.”](#) Mark Schafer and Isaiah F. A.
Cohen. *Louisiana Agriculture Magazine*.
- 2012 [“The Impact of Homeschooling on the Adjustment of College Students.”](#) Cynthia Drenovsky
and Isaiah Cohen. *International Social Science Review*. 87(1-2):19-34.

MANUSCRIPTS WITH STUDENTS (IN PROGRESS)

“Sustainable Consumption under Structural Constraint: An Exploratory Mixed Methods Study in Native American Reservation Communities.” Glen Marshall, Rand Wergin, and Isaiah F. A. Cohen.
Currently under review at *Journal of Macromarketing*.

“Exploring the Pathways to College: K-12 Schooling Modality and Collegiate Adjustment.” Isaiah F. A. Cohen, Pema Sherpa, and Justin Berg. Currently under review at *Sociological Inquiry*.

“Exploring the Gap: Gender's Impact on High School & Collegiate Performance.” Isaiah Cohen and Nicholas Boon. Preparing for Submission to *Journal of Educational and Behavioral Statistics*.

“Exploring the Impact of COVID-19 on Matriculation and Student Mental Health.” Isaiah Cohen and Tarynn Ball. Preparing for submission to *International Social Science Review*.

USD GRANTS

October 2025 University of South Dakota: Arts & Sciences Travel Grant (\$1,000)

February 2025 University of South Dakota: Arts & Sciences Travel Grant (\$750)

February 2024 University of South Dakota: Arts & Sciences Travel Grant (\$750)

PENDING GRANTS/IN PREPARATION

February 2026 Mellon Foundation (\$500,000)

February 2026 National Science Foundation (\$600,000)

SUBMITTED/NOT FUNDED GRANTS

September 2024 National Endowment for the Humanities (\$150,000)

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS WITH STUDENTS

2026 “Sustainability Signals, Structural Constraints, and Grocery Choice in Underserved Markets.”
Glen Marshall, Rand Wergin, and Isaiah Cohen will be presenting at the 2026 Macromarketing Conference, Denver, CO.

2026 “Utilitarianism in American Media: Nationalism and Rhetoric during Times of Crisis.” Aadil Ali and Isaiah Cohen will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.

2026 “Redefining the Nuclear Family? Exploring Gen Z Perspectives on Relationships and the Family.” Isaiah Cohen, Skyler De Boer, and Tristan Helgeson will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.

2026 “Coping Under Pressure: How Sociodemographic Background Shapes Mental Health and Stress Management in Competitive Academic Majors.” Tarynn Ball and Isaiah Cohen will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.

2026 “Is It Art, Craft, or Something in Between? How College Students Assess and Consume Art in the Digital Age.” Isaiah Cohen, Nile Patterson, and Nicholas Boon will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.

2026 “American Society Perspectives on AI and its Applications.” Muhammad Danish Aheed and Isaiah Cohen will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.

- 2026 “Exploring the Impact of COVID-19 on Matriculation and Student Mental Health.” Isaiah Cohen and Tarynn Ball will be presenting at Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO.
- 2026 “Barriers and Opportunities in Underserved Markets: Insights for Sustainable Business and Social Entrepreneurs.” Glen Marshall, Rand Wergin, and Isaiah Cohen presented at the Beacom Scholar Series, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “The Influence of K-12 Education on Collegiate Matriculation and Wellbeing.” Isaiah F. A. Cohen, Pema Sherpa, and Justin Berg presented at the American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 “Exploring the Gap: Gender’s Impact on High School and Collegiate Performance.” Isaiah Cohen and Nicholas Boon presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) Social Science Interdisciplinary Consortium, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “Unconventional Allies: Exploring the Experiences of African Male Feminists.” Josephine Saighoe and Isaiah Cohen presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) Social Science Interdisciplinary Consortium, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “Exploring the Impact of COVID-19 on Matriculation and Student Mental Health.” Tarynn Ball and Isaiah Cohen presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) Social Science Interdisciplinary Consortium, Vermillion, SD,
- 2025 “The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on the Quality of Higher Education.” Pragati Rouniyar, and Isaiah Cohen presented at IdeaFest, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “American Society Perspectives on AI and its Applications.” Muhammad Danish Aheed, Isaiah Cohen, and Rodrigue Rizk presented at IdeaFest, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “Did I Homeschool Me? A Qualitative Exploration of Matriculated Homeschooled Student Experiences.” Isaiah Cohen and Moriah Scorzafava presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) IdeaFest, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 ““Hands Off My School”: Exploring State Regulation of Homeschooling.” Isaiah Cohen and Zakary Cason presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) IdeaFest, Vermillion, SD.
- 2025 “Blasé Attitude and the Tragedy of Culture in the Age of Social Media.” Isaiah Cohen, Nicholas Boon, Shelsy Santos Segovia, and Brooke Hanneman presented at 1) Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, & 2) IdeaFest, Vermillion, SD.

USD AWARDS AND HONORS

<i>2026 Office of Multicultural Affairs Champion</i> , University of South Dakota	February 25, 2026
<i>Belbas-Larson Award for Excellence in Teaching</i> , University of South Dakota	Nominated February 2026
<i>Belbas-Larson Award for Excellence in Teaching</i> , University of South Dakota	Nominated January 2025
<i>SGA Professor of the Year</i> , University of South Dakota	Nominated April 2024
<i>Belbas-Larson Award for Excellence in Teaching</i> , University of South Dakota	Nominated January 2024

TEACHING & MENTORING TRAINING

National Research Mentoring Network: (2024) Unconscious Bias and Identity, Mentoring Graduate Students, Post Docs & Early Career Faculty, and Mentoring Undergraduate Students.

American Sociological Association: (2025) Network Mapping Techniques for Enhanced Learning and Engagement in the Classroom.

Midwest Sociological Society: (2025) Alpha Kappa Delta (AKD) Teaching and Learning Workshop, BYOB: "Bring Your Own Brilliance", Teaching & Learning Workshop, Teaching Sociology in 2025: Coffee & Networking; (2024) Integrating Data Analysis into Substantive Sociological Courses.

University of South Dakota: (2025) Completed Howard Hughes Medical Institute Professors (HHMI) Entering Mentoring 10-Week Program.

University of South Dakota Center for Teaching and Learning (USD-CTL): (2025) Digital Accessibility Fellowship, Course Design Fellowship, and Open Textbook Fellowship; (2024) Online Faculty Symposium and Turnitin/Feedback Studio.

USD TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lower-Division Courses: SOC 100 Introduction to Sociology [Multiple Modalities], SOC 150 Social Problems, and SOC 211 Social Science Writing [Online].

Upper-Division Courses: SOC 392 Sociology of Gaming, SOC 392 Sociology of Pop Culture [Multiple Modalities], SOC 402 Social Deviance [Multiple Modalities], SOC 410 Methods of Social Research, SOC 480 Sociology of Education, and SOC 491 Independent Study: Sociological Ethnography.

PhD Dissertation Committee

- Member - Glen Marshall (Sustainability) and Sonja Braucht (Sustainability).

Honors Thesis Committee

- Honors Thesis Director - Tarynn Ball (Medical Biology), Pragati Rouniyar (Computer Science), and Allison Young (Psychology).
- Honors Thesis Committee - Makia Adler (Sociology), Emmalee Bosma (Sociology), Nicholas Boon (Sociology), and Aysia Hall (Criminal Justice).

INVITED LECTURES AND SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

South Dakota Community

- Keynote Speaker – The Rise of Modern Antisemitism: A Spotlight Panel Discussion (October 22nd, 2025)
- Keynote Speaker – October 7th: Bearing Witness to the Massacre (October 6th, 2025)
- Keynote Speaker – Commemorating October 7th: An Evening of Remembrance, Reflection, and Renewal (October 7th, 2024)

South Dakota Legislature

- Expert Testimony – House Judiciary Hearing on HB 1076 (January 19, 2024)

University of South Dakota

- Guest Lecturer – SUST 790: World Religions (Fall 2024)

- Guest Lecturer – REL 250: World Religions, (Fall, yearly: 2021-2023)
- Guest Lecturer – Anthropology 210: Cultural Anthropology (Fall 2021)

MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

Dakota News Now – [South Dakota leaders react to Bondi Beach Attack](#), December 15, 2025.

Argus Leader – “[USD professors condemn antisemitism, Islamophobia in light of Israel/Hamas War in Gaza](#)”.
November 23, 2023.

SDPB – “[USD professor condemns hate as Israel-Palestine conflict rages](#).” November 17, 2023.

WORKSHOPS

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| Workshop Organizer – Ungrading the Unessay: Rethinking Assessment through Creativity
and Choice. 2026 Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting. | 2026 |
| Workshop Organizer – Ungrading the Unessay , The Grading Conference | 2024 |
| Workshop Organizer – Field Learning Assignments, University of South Dakota | 2021 |

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

University of South Dakota

- Member, UDiscover Summer Scholars Committee, 2026.
- Chair, College of Arts & Sciences: Social Science Division, 2024-2025.
- Vice Chair, College of Arts & Sciences: Social Science Division, 2023-2024.
- Member, USD AI Symposium Publicity Committee, 2024.
- Member, USD Faculty Senate Nominating Committee, 2024-Present.
- Member, USD Faculty Senate Lambda Chi Teaching Award Committee, 2023.
- Member, University Senate, 2023-2025.
- Marshall, Spring Commencement, 2021-Present.
- Move-In-Day Volunteer, Fall Move-In, 2021.
- Creator and Organizer, Social Science Interdisciplinary Consortium Conference, 2020-Present.
- Advisor, Jewish Student Organization (2024-Present), Artificial Intelligence Club, (2024-Present), Yote Pack Anthro (2024-2025), Libertarian Youth Caucus (2023-2024), Young Americans for Liberty (2021-2024), and Sociology Club (2020-Present).
- Event Organizer, Department of Anthropology and Sociology, 2020-Present.

Community, Discipline, & Public Engagement

- Member, Academic Engagement Network (2025-Present), Faculty Against Antisemitism Movement (2024-Present), and Heterodox Academy (2021-Present).
- Member, MSS Minority Scholars Committee, 2024-Present.
- (Faculty) Member, Muslim Students Association (2025-Present) and Indian Students Association (2024-Present).
- Host, American Cultural Exchange Service, 2023.
- Supervisor, South Dakota Science Olympiad (Write It Do It), 2023-Present.
- Editorial Board Member, Contexts Magazine, American Sociological Association, 2021-2024.